

THE BLUE CARD CALENDAR



5774

THE BLUE CARD is a charitable organization that has been aiding Holocaust survivors since 1939. It is dedicated to the support of European Jewish survivors in this country and their descendants, who still suffer from the aftereffects of Nazi persecution, are sick or emotionally unstable, have been unable to achieve economic independence, or have lost it through sickness or old age; in many cases the Holocaust has deprived them of a supporting family. The Blue Card's activities aren't duplicated by any other Jewish welfare agencies. During the year 2012, the Blue Card made grants amounting to nearly \$1.6 million. This brings the grant total since the Blue Card's inception to \$23.6 million.

THE BLUE CARD mirrors the social conscience of our community. We hope it will be your favorite charity, and that you will remember it in your last will. Your contribution is fully tax deductible.

THE BLUE CARD has been publishing this calendar for its friends and friends-to-be for more than 50 years, in order to remind them throughout the year that there is an organization which is always ready to render assistance to our neediest.

PLEASE SEE *the inside back cover of this calendar for more information about The Blue Card.*

A copy of the most recent financial report may be obtained from The Blue Card, Inc., 171 Madison Ave. Suite 1405, New York, NY 10016.

Front cover: The Ghetto Heroes Monument in Warsaw, unveiled in 1948, is on the site where the first armed fighting took place between Ghetto partisans and the Germans.

Back cover: construction of part of the Warsaw Ghetto wall in 1940.

THE BLUE CARD CALENDAR

For 5774 (2013-2014 C.E.)

ITS THEME:

THE WARSAW GHETTO UPRISING

Published by

THE BLUE CARD, Inc.®

Serving needy Jewish Holocaust survivors since 1939

171 Madison Ave., Suite 1405

New York, NY 10016, USA

Tel.: (212) 239-2251

Fax: (212) 594-6881

Visit our Web site: www.BlueCardFund.org

E-mail: info@bluecardfund.org



5774

INTRODUCTION

The year 2013 marks the 70th anniversary of the Warsaw Ghetto Uprising, where for 11 days, a relative handful of poorly equipped Jewish fighters resisted a massively superior German force. It is a story of heroism and human spirit.

Germany's invasion of Poland began on September 17, 1939. After the siege of Warsaw, the Germans entered the city on October 1. Construction of the walls of the Warsaw Ghetto began on April 1, 1940, and by mid-November of 1940, about 400,000 Jews had been forced to live within the ghetto's confines, an area of just 1.3 square miles. Numbers were later augmented by Jews from surrounding areas and by Romany people ("Gypsies").

The inhabitants of the ghetto lived in conditions of increasing desperation. More than 100,000 are thought to have died from disease or starvation. The smuggling of provisions from outside the ghetto became a principal means of sustenance.

In July 1942, mass deportations, most to the Treblinka camp, began. It is believed that within two months, between 250,000 and 300,000 Jews were deported, almost all of them to their deaths. It became clear to those who remained in the ghetto that those who were deported were being killed, rather than resettled as the Germans were saying.

In response, many of the remaining residents decided to organize to defend themselves. July 1942 saw the formation of the Jewish Combat Organization, known by its Polish acronym ZOB, which grew to about 500 members. An allied organization, the Jewish Military Union (ZZW), had another 250. The initial resistance took place in January 1943, when fighters (most of whom died) sufficiently disrupted the efforts of the Germans to liquidate the ghetto that deportations were temporarily suspended.

On April 19, 1943 (Passover eve), the Germans resumed their efforts to liquidate the ghetto, only to find most of its remaining residents in hiding and to encounter armed resistance from the Jewish fighters.

Although badly outnumbered and outgunned, the Jewish resistance killed a dozen German soldiers and temporarily succeeded in driving the German forces out of the ghetto.

But the Germans returned in force and began, block by block, to raze and burn the ghetto. By the end of April, the resistance had effectively ended. On May 8, the Germans discovered the bunker at Mila 18 which held the ZOB leadership, and those Jews who did not escape committed mass suicide.

After that, some Jews remained in hiding in the ghetto, but it is likely that none remained after November 1943. The German commander reported that more than 7,000 Jews were killed in the operations that began in April 1943, and it is likely that more than 50,000 were deported during that time. In all, at least 300,000 Jews who lived in the Warsaw ghetto, and possibly many more, perished. Perhaps about 10,000 Jews escaped from the ghetto to the Gentile side of Warsaw.

The story of the Warsaw Ghetto Uprising is one of incredible bravery and determination — a triumph of humanity against those who would destroy. In this calendar, we briefly tell just a few of the stories from that period.

This year's edition was edited by Ralph Hammelbacher. Hella Hammelbacher created the original design, which was ably realized by Jacqueline Enrique.

There are vast resources for finding out more about the Warsaw Ghetto and the uprising. Yad Vashem has an excellent collection of oral histories at <http://bit.ly/18jY6Nx>, and the U.S. Holocaust Memorial Museum has many resources, both online and at the museum itself. The accounts here draw on the New York Times obituaries of Marek Edelman and Boruch Spiegel. Bea Stadtler's "The Holocaust: A History of Courage and Resistance" is one of many books that tell stories of those who fought. Films such as "Uprising" and "The Pianist" vividly depict the uprising.



Marek Edelman was one of the leaders of the uprising, and the one of the few to survive the war. As one of those given passes to forestall the deportation of those deemed too ill to travel, he used the passes to keep people behind who would be useful to the Resistance. He used his knowledge of the ghetto to help Resistance fighters who were pinned down to escape. When the ghetto was burned, he and several comrades escaped through the sewer system and were given shelter elsewhere in Warsaw. He remained in Poland, became a noted cardiologist, and died in 2009.

Elul 5773 - Tishri 5774				SEPTEMBER 2013		
SUNDAY	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY	SATURDAY
1	2 Labor Day	3	4 Erev Rosh Hashana	5 Tishri 1 5774 Rosh Hashana	6 Rosh Hashana Second Day	7
8	9	10	11	12	13 Erev Yom Kippur	14 Yom Kippur
15	16	17	18	19 Succoth 1st Day	20 Succoth 2nd Day	21
22	23	24	25 Hoshana Rabba	26 Shemini Atzeret	27 Simchat Torah	28
29	30					



This famous photograph of captive women was taken by the Germans. Malka Zdrojewicz (on the right) was one of many women who aided the resistance. Years later, she recalled: “We went to a neutral place in the ghetto area and climbed down into the underground sewers. Through them, we girls used to carry arms into the ghetto; we hid them in our boots. During the ghetto uprising, we hurled Molotov cocktails at the Germans. After the suppression of the uprising, we went into hiding, taking refuge in an underground shelter where a large quantity of arms was piled up. But the Germans detected us and forced us out.”

She was taken to the Majdanek concentration camp, where she survived. She emigrated to Palestine, where she married and had four children.

Tishri - Heshvan 5774						OCTOBER 2013
SUNDAY	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY	SATURDAY
		1	2	3	4	5 Heshvan 1
6	7	8	9	10	11	12
13	14 Columbus Day	15	16	17	18	19
20	21	22	23	24	25	26
27	28	29	30	31		



Bea Stadtler's book "The Holocaust: A History of Courage and Resistance" tells the story: "Zofia Zamaika, an underground leader, escaped to the forest, was caught, and was put on a train to Treblinka. She jumped from the train, pretended she was dead, and finally returned to Warsaw. In Warsaw she worked on an underground paper, was captured again, and was put into a German prison. She was finally allowed to go free and went once more into the forest. Her group was attacked by 300 Germans, and she and two Poles covered the retreat of the Polish partisan unit. Zofia manned the machine gun, and although the three were killed, even Germans praised her bravery."

Heshvan - Kislev 5774				NOVEMBER 2013		
SUNDAY	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY	SATURDAY
					1	2
3	4	5	6	7	8	9
Daylight Time Ends	Kislev 1					
10	11	12	13	14	15	16
	Veteran's Day					
17	18	19	20	21	22	23
24	25	26	27	28	29	30
			Hanukkah First Candle	Hanukkah First Day Thanksgiving		



When the purpose of the deportations of Jews became clear, the Warsaw's Jewish Labor Bund and other organizations joined to form the Jewish Combat Organization (ZOB). Boruch Spiegel was a member of the Bund and became a leader of the resistance. "We didn't have enough weapons; we didn't have enough bullets," he later said. "It was like fighting a well-equipped army with firecrackers." Spiegel was on guard duty on the morning of April 19, 1943 when the German military surrounded the Ghetto, and gave the order to begin the uprising.

He escaped through the sewers with, among others, a fellow fighter, named Chaike Belchatowska. They and others joined with Polish partisans to continue fighting. The two later married and lived in Sweden and then Montreal.

Kislev - Tevet 5774				DECEMBER 2013		
SUNDAY	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY	SATURDAY
1	2	3	4 Tevet 1	5 Hanukkah 8th Day	6	7
8	9	10	11	12	13	14
15	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24	25 Christmas Day	26	27	28
29	30	31 New Year's Eve				



Mordechai Anielewicz became leader of the ZOB in November, 1942, at the age of 23. Born near Warsaw, he joined the socialist Zionist youth organization. After the Germans invaded Poland, he undertook various resistance activities and was imprisoned by the Soviets as he was trying to open a route to Palestine for Polish Jews. On his return to Warsaw, he joined the ZOB and was instrumental in the actions of January 18, 1943, when armed resistance to the Germans temporarily halted the deportation of Jews. He likely died as part of a mass suicide, on May 8, 1943 when the Germans attacked ZOB headquarters at Mila 18. Anielewicz was posthumously honored with monuments, street names and an Israeli postage stamp.

Tevet - Shevat 5774				JANUARY 2014		
SUNDAY	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY	SATURDAY
			1 New Year's Day	2 Shevat 1	3	4
5	6	7	8	9	10	11
12	13	14	15	16 Tu B'Shevat	17	18
19	20 Martin Luther King Jr. Day	21	22	23	24	25
26	27	28	29	30	31	



Simcha Rotem, a native of Warsaw, joined the ZOB in 1942, at the age of 18. He adopted “Kazik” as his nom de guerre. Because he was able to pass as Aryan, he was able to impersonate a Polish soldier and undertake missions to rescue Jews captured by the Germans. He was one of the leaders of the uprising. Trapped on the Gentile side of Warsaw when the Nazis discovered the passageway he used, he eventually returned to the ghetto through the sewers and led Zivia Lubetkin (see March, 2014) and about 80 other fighters back to the Gentile side and then to the forest, where they continued resistance activities.

He eventually emigrated to Palestine, and remains alive in 2013, one of the last survivors of the uprising.

Adar 5774						FEBRUARY 2014	
SUNDAY	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY	SATURDAY	
						1	
						Adar 1	
2	3	4	5	6	7	8	
9	10	11	12	13	14	15	
			Lincoln's Birthday		Valentine's Day		
16	17	18	19	20	21	22	
	Presidents Day					Washington's Birthday	
23	24	25	26	27	28		



Zivia Lubetkin became a Zionist in her teens. In 1939 she went to Geneva for a Zionist congress, then returned to a part of Poland which was occupied by the Soviets after war broke out. She made her way at great risk to Warsaw, where she joined the underground. She was one of the founders of the ZOB and participated in several of its leadership groups. During the uprising, she was instrumental in maintaining communications between the various groups of fighters. With other fighters, she escaped to the Gentile side of Warsaw through the sewers.

After the war, she helped Jews emigrate to Palestine, and eventually settled there, married Yizhak Zuckerman (see April, 2014) and lived on a kibbutz until her death in 1976. In 1961, she testified at the trial of Adolf Eichmann.

Adar - Adar II 5774						MARCH 2014
SUNDAY	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY	SATURDAY
						1
2	3 Adar II 1	4	5	6	7	8
9 Daylight Time Begins	10	11	12	13	14	15 Erev Purim
16 Purim	17	18	19	20	21	22
23	24	25	26	27	28	29
30	31					



Yizhak Zuckerman was born Icchak Cukierman in Vilnius, now the capital of Lithuania. He went to Warsaw in 1940, where he became a leader of Jewish youth organizations and also met his future wife, Zivia Lubetkin (see March, 2014). He was one of the founders of the ZOB. On a mission to Krakow, where he and companions attacked a café used by the Nazis, he was seriously wounded in the leg. He became one of the ZOB commanders, but shortly before the uprising, he was ordered to the Gentile side of Warsaw to help the ZOB there. He supplied weapons for the uprising, and organized the rescue of fighters through the sewer system.

After the war, he helped Jews emigrate to Palestine, then moved there, where he lived with his wife until his death in 1981.

Adar II - Nisan 5774				APRIL 2014		
SUNDAY	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY	SATURDAY
		1	2 Nisan 1	3	4	5
6	7	8	9	10	11	12
13	14 Erev Passover	15 Passover 1st Day	16	17	18	19
20 Easter Sunday	21	22 Passover 8th Day	23	24	25	26
27	28 Yom Hashoah	29	30			



Ben Meed (born Benjamin Miedzyrzecki) was born in 1918 to a religious family in Warsaw. After the German invasion, he fled to the Soviet-occupied part of Poland, but then returned to be with his family, who by then had been forced to move to the ghetto. He was assigned to work outside the ghetto, and used his knowledge and access to smuggle food and arms into the ghetto and Jews out. One of those he aided was Vladka Peltel, a ZOB member; the two would later marry. He posed as a Catholic and hid on the Polish side of the city, helping rescue resistance fighters. In oral testimony many years later, he recounted the burning of the ghetto: "The entire sky of Warsaw was red. Completely red. But the flames were so concentrated around the whole ghetto that it illuminated the whole city."

Settling in the U.S., the Meeds established the American Gathering of Jewish Holocaust Survivors, were active in the founding of the U.S. Holocaust Memorial Museum, and established a registry of Holocaust survivors and their descendents — www.ushmm.org/remembrance/registry.

Iyar - Sivan 5774				MAY 2014		
SUNDAY	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY	SATURDAY
				1 Iyar 1	2	3
4	5	6 Israel Independence Day	7	8	9	10
11 Mother's Day	12	13	14	15	16	17
18 Lag B'Omer	19	20	21	22	23	24
25	26 Memorial Day	27	28	29	30 Sivan 1	31



Peretz Hochman's family was sent to the Warsaw Ghetto in 1940, when Peretz was just 13. Not long after, he began sneaking out to the Gentile side of Warsaw, bringing back food and clothing he bought on the black market. In 1942, both his parents died — his father starved to death and his mother was shot by a German officer. Peretz and his brother Zane then escaped to the other side, and together with other children sold newspapers and cigarettes. They slept in stairways and cemeteries. Given Polish identity cards, the Hochman brothers stayed in Warsaw, participating in the 1944 Warsaw Uprising. They were eventually taken by the Germans to a prison, where they were released in 1945. Hochman emigrated to Palestine in 1946.

Sivan - Tammuz 5774				JUNE 2014		
SUNDAY	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY	SATURDAY
1	2	3 Erev Shavuot	4 Shavuot 1st Day	5	6	7
8	9	10	11	12	13	14
15 Father's Day	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24	25	26	27	28
29 Tammuz 1	30					

When the Germans encountered resistance upon entering the ghetto on April 19, 1943, the German commander Jürgen Stroop ordered that it be razed and burned, even as fighting with the members of the ghetto resistance continued.

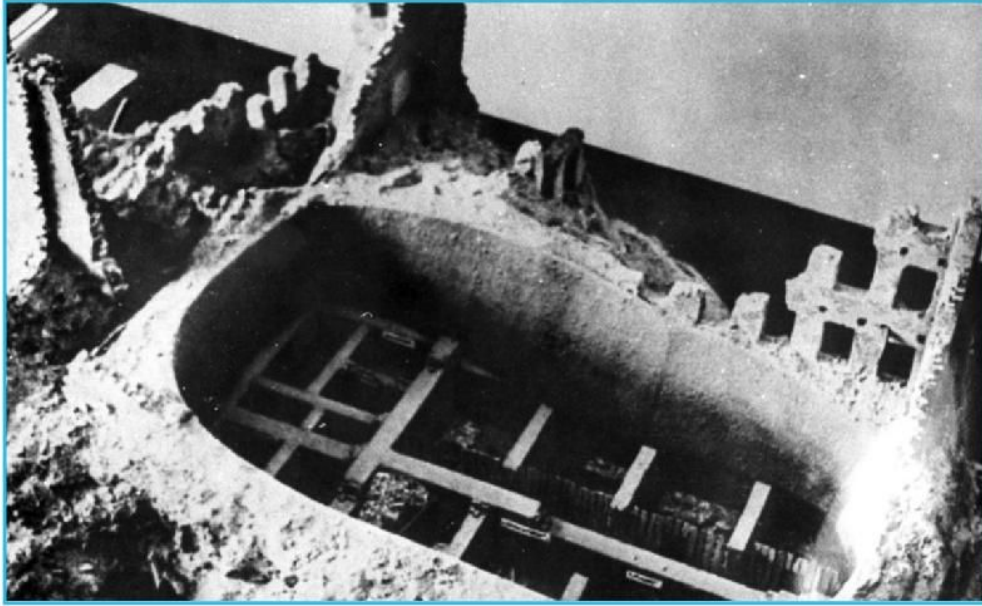
Stroop's report said: "Over and over again new battle groups consisting of 20 to 30 or more Jewish fellows, 18 to 25 years of age, accompanied by a corresponding number of women, kindled new resistance. These battle groups were under orders to put up armed resistance to the last and if necessary to escape arrest by committing suicide....During this armed resistance the



women belonging to the battle groups were equipped the same as the men....Not infrequently, these women fired pistols with both hands, or hand grenades (Polish "pineapple" hand grenades), concealed in their bloomers up to the last moment to use against the men of the Waffen, SS, Police, or Wehrmacht....The resistance put up by the Jews and the bandits could be broken only by relentlessly using all our force and energy day and night...."

Tammuz - Av 5774						JULY 2014
SUNDAY	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY	SATURDAY
		1	2	3	4 Independence Day	5
6	7	8	9	10	11	12
13	14	15	16	17	18	19
20	21	22	23	24	25	26
27	28 Av 1	29	30	31		

Even after May 1943, hundreds of Jews, including resistance fighters, managed to survive in the ruins of the ghetto, hiding in bunkers that they camouflaged. Conditions in many of the bunkers were indescribable — cramped, wet and without toilets. Jews would stay in the bunkers by day, and go out at night to look for whatever food they could find that had been discarded by German soldiers. Cut off, sometimes buried under rubble from collapsed houses, starving, only a handful of fighters managed to survive. By November 1943, the last of the Jews were likely gone from the ghetto.



Av - Elul 5774				AUGUST 2014		
SUNDAY	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY	SATURDAY
					1	2
3	4	5 Tisha B'Av	6	7	8	9
10	11	12	13	14	15	16
17	18	19	20	21	22	23
24 31	25	26	27 Elul 1	28	29	30



Mila 18, or 18 Mila ["Pleasant"] Street, was the address of the bunker that was the last headquarters of the ZOB. It was originally built by smugglers (who assisted the ZOB), but when the previous ZOB headquarters down the street were destroyed by the Germans, the ZOB leadership moved to Mila 18. They remained there for a full three weeks after the start of the uprising, until on May 8, 1943, the bunker was discovered. Rather than surrender, many of the resistance fighters are thought to have killed themselves, while some were led by Simcha Rotem to the Polish side of the city.

The bodies of those who died remain buried beneath the rubble, and no building was constructed there afterward. A monument commemorates those who died there.

Elul 5774 - Tishri 5775				SEPTEMBER 2014		
SUNDAY	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY	SATURDAY
	1 Labor Day	2	3	4	5	6
7	8	9	10	11	12	13
14	15	16	17	18	19	20
21	22	23	24 Erev Rosh Hashana	25 Tishri 1 5775 Rosh Hashana	26 Rosh Hashana Second Day	27
28	29	30				

By the middle of 1943, the destruction was complete. With the Germans having burned and razed virtually all the ghetto, there was nothing left to destroy. Scenes such as this are what Soviet troops encountered when they liberated Warsaw from German occupation on January 17, 1945.



Tishri - Heshvan 5775				OCTOBER 2014		
SUNDAY	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY	SATURDAY
			1	2	3 Erev Yom Kippur	4 Yom Kippur
5	6	7	8	9 Succoth 1st Day	10 Succoth 2nd Day	11
12	13 Columbus Day	14	15 Hoshana Rabba	16 Shemini Atzeret	17 Simchat Torah	18
19	20	21	22	23	24	25 Heshvan 1
26	27	28	29	30	31	



Established in Germany in 1934, The Blue Card's sole purpose was to provide financial assistance to Jews fleeing from that country's growing persecution. It was re-established in the United States in 1939, to continue aiding refugees escaping from the Nazi horror. Today, it is the only organization in the United States whose sole mission is to aid needy Holocaust survivors by providing cash assistance — to survivors all across the country.

By the end of 2012, we distributed over \$1.7 million to survivors, whose ages ranged from 70 to 108 years.

Description of Our Programs

The Blue Card provides assistance through eight different programs:

Emergency Cash Assistance: provides for survivors' most immediate needs by helping with the cost of dental care, medicine, rent, food and other essentials.

The Holocaust Survivor Emergency Cash Assistance Program is funded by the Claims Conference on Jewish Material Claims Against Germany.

Dental Care: The Dental Program proudly carries the name of Curt C. and Else Silberman Foundation. The program provides funds for most urgent dental care needs faced by destitute Holocaust survivors across the United States.

Stipend Program: supports the most indigent survivors with monthly checks of \$150 to \$300.

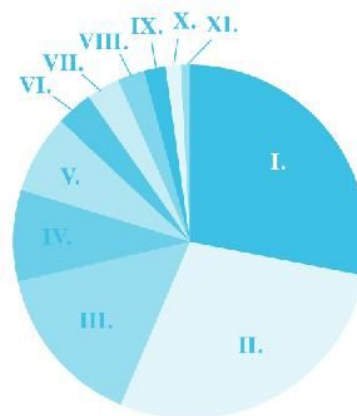
Jewish Holiday Program: provides \$200 for the High Holidays, \$200 for Hanukkah and \$200 for Passover, giving survivors the financial means to have a happier holiday season.

The Summer Vacation Program: named after Adolph and Lotte Rosenberg, this offers a free summer vacation program to needy survivors in the New York area, providing them with handicap-accessible accommodations, transportation, scheduled meals and a well planned itinerary, making the program structured, safe, and group-oriented.

The Emergency Response Program: named after Jakob Mogilnik, this provides a system for Holocaust survivors who do not have the financial resources to pay for installation, service, and maintenance. When a survivor presses a button (either around the neck or on the wrist), a speakerphone is automatically activated, and programmed into the system is the native language of the survivor. The operator answers in Yiddish, German,

The Blue Card's 2012 Grants at Glance:

I.	Monthly Stipend	\$455,000
II.	Dental Care	\$455,000
III.	Telephone Emergency Response	\$240,700
IV.	Emergency Cash Assistance	\$135,000
V.	Jewish Holiday Grant	\$115,250
VI.	Hurricane Sandy Relief	\$55,000
VII.	Birthday Program	\$50,200
VIII.	Homecare	\$39,550
IX.	Bring A Smile	\$28,600
X.	Summer Vacation	\$25,700
XI.	Vitamin Program	\$10,000
Total		\$1,610,000



Russian, Hungarian or any language that the survivor speaks, and then follows up on the emergency.

Mazel Tov Birthday Program: provides survivors with a \$100 check and a card on their birthday.

Vitamins Program: provides Holocaust survivors with multivitamins and minerals.

Bring a Smile Program: we are looking to expand our efforts by seeking out these survivors who have life-threatening diseases and may need additional support at this difficult time. The program is very similar to what the Make-a-Wish Foundation does for terminally ill children.

Minnie's Place: a multi-sensory room for emotional healing in conjunction with The Hebrew Educational Society. This unique environment is available to survivors to help them cope with anxiety and stress.

The Saggi B. Wilzig Fighting Cancer Together program: aid to Holocaust survivors battling cancer. Assistance is available for transportation to appointments and treatments, medical co-pays, and nutrition.

Charitable Standing

In 2012, Charity Navigator announced that The Blue Card earned its **eighth consecutive four-star rating** for its ability to deliver its services in a cost-effective manner. Fewer than 10% of rated charities have received at least four consecutive four-star evaluations, indicating that The Blue Card outperforms most charities in America in its efforts to operate in the most fiscally responsible way possible.



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